

complex issue of how ownership applies when machine-generated music is based on human-created content, which we will discuss later.

Currently, the most effective implementations of AI in music arise when technology is used to “collaborate” with musicians rather than supplant them. Instances include the band Yacht providing an AI with their complete back catalogue to produce new material and artist Holly Herndon creating her own AI that could “harmonize” with her on an album and tour, both of which received critical acclaim.

Brands have also joined in on the AI music trend. In the previous year, Glaceau Smartwater sponsored a collaboration between AI startup Endel and Toro Y Moi, producing four tracks named after Smartwater products. Additionally, LG partnered with Amper Music and Australian artist Betty Who to create “the most motivational song ever” by analyzing hundreds of motivational songs and playlists. The outcome was performed at LG’s Color Run event in Los Angeles.

The interpretation of musical data by AI can lead to intriguing outcomes, whether intended or not. A case in point is SKYGGE, also known as French artist Benoit Carré, who fed the program Flow-Machines with 1980s French pop music and then molded the output into a 50-minute album called ‘Hello World’. This album is considered the first fully AI-assisted album. Carré followed up with ‘Black is the Colour’ in 2022, which replaced the French pop dataset with traditional American folk songs. In both cases, the resulting music retains traces of the source material, yet emerges in novel and surprising ways.

Music Production

Although the impact of AI on music composition may appear vague, its influence on music production is more tangible and practical, involving less revolution and more refinement. As an illustration, an AI studio tool can expedite time-consuming studio processes or determine the most appropriate compression settings for various genres by analyzing a vast dataset of recordings.

The emergence of AI programs like LANDR has been especially beneficial for musicians. These programs provide access to the intricate, multifaceted, and often costly process of mastering a track, while continually refining and enhancing their algorithms. Although these programs may not yet measure up to top-notch mastering or studio engineers, the capability to transform demo-quality recordings into polished tracks with a simple click can assist musicians in not only saving money, but also possibly expediting the production of broadcast-quality music.